Thapar and Bogey Sen. On the morning of 28 October, Palit, had been called to brief the defence minister. '…just as I rose to take my leave, he abruptly asked, "Do you think we ought to bring back retired generals to take charge of the war?" The question was as unexpected as it was loaded and he had asked it with a sly look on his face. I realized at once what he was alluding to. There had been a great deal of talk as well as suggestions in the press that the government should recall Thimayya and Thorat to service to take command of the army. I pretended to misunderstand his meaning and replied that in times of war it was always open to the government to recall retired officers from the reserve list.

'"I was talking about *generals*," he snapped. "They say we need some retired generals to fight the Chinese."'